

film reviews Ear Candy

ROCK ON!!

Rating: ★★☆☆

Director: Abhishek Kapoor

Starring: Farhan Akhtar, Arjun Rampal, Purab Kohli

So he can direct, act, sing (well in a raspy smoke-roughened sort of way), and guess what, he can look good even with his top off (in the shower and down by the sea). Which is why you don't really mind that in this year of deliciously young male diversions in Bollywood, a veritable veteran at 34, who looks disconcertingly like his dad, has made his acting debut. Yes, ladies and gentlemen, we're talking about Farhan Akhtar and though *Rock On!!* has very little to do with rock music, it is a movie that's refreshing. One, it's got impossibly cool haircuts—with each of the four principal actors getting two looks for the price of one. Two, it's got lovely non-rock music with hummable lyrics (listen especially to *Kabhi khud pe hasa main/aur kabhi khud pe*



THE RIGHT TONE: (L to R) Kohli, Akhtar, Kenny and Rampal

roya). Three, and this is important in a movie that carries two exclamation marks in its title, it is surprisingly quiet and thoughtful. There's a band of four who reunite 10 years after they break up because of ego hassles between the two stars. Each of the band members is given a back story that keeps the audience engaged, yes, even Arjun Rampal who makes up for the lack of visible drug-use in this squeaky clean movie by looking stoned throughout the

movie (and having his long hair permanently subjected to the ministrations of a studio fan). Unusually, for a movie about guys, even the women are feisty. The schmaltzy Hallmark ending is expected but not grating. Boys will love the mock rock concerts (complete with Akhtar peeling off his jacket and leaping into the crowd) and girls will love, well, the boys. And their toys. There is something to be said for men with guitars and drums. Actually, quite a lot.

by Kaveer Banzal

Deadly Dull

CHAMKU

Rating: ★☆☆☆

Director: Kabeer Kaushik

Starring: Bobby Deol, Priyanka Chopra

Why would Bollywood need another Sunny Deol when it already has Akshay Kumar? Perhaps the Family Deol believes giving baby Bobby some serious biceps and a permanent frown is enough to keep the action man territory in the family. The movie begins well enough, with a taut ac-

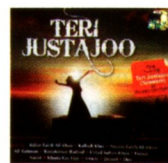


POINTLESS PUNCH FEST: Priyanka and Bobby

tion scene on a train, reminiscent of Kaushik's climax in *Seher*, but everything is downhill from then on. The colour of blood, of which there is a lot, is variable, the make-up is mouldy and the song intervals (one for every festival) are ridiculous despite Priyanka Chopra's alluring backless blouses. The story of a former Naxalite turning into a hitman for the government is intriguing but never fully developed. Fists fly, bullets whizz and blood flows like mercuriochrome, but no violence is violent enough for the Brothers Deol.

-KB

music reviews Unique Notes



Sony-BMG

TERI JUSTAJOO

This is the best Sufi compilation from film and private

albums because it has a variety of voices and the songs are all hits. And it ranges from Ustad Fateh Ali Khan to KK, including *Saiyaan* by Kailash Kher, *Teri Justajoo* by Roop Kumar Rathod, *Mora Saiyaan* by Shafaqat Ali Khan or *Maujood hain* by Jaswinder Singh and *Shaaam dhale* by Ustad Sultan Khan and Chitra. All these songs are inspired by qawwali, classical and the Sufi genre. The imaginative rhythmic accompaniment adds to the uniqueness of the songs. A must-have for those who are always craving for good music.



Big Music

1920
Why did Indian classical vocalist, Pandit Jasraj have

to sing for a film song that is weak in melody? The song *Vaada* does not register in one's mind. The same song has been sung by classical vocalist Parveen Sultana (of *Hume tumse pyar kitna* from *Kudrat*). The composer Adnan Sami has roped in Shubha Mudgal to sing *Bichuwa*. Mudgal was surprised to know that her song was turned into an item number featuring Rakhi Sawant. Nevertheless, the song is peppy. For a change, Kailash Kher is singing a slow number, *Tujhe pyaar karoon* and it is soothing and captures the cry for a loved one. Seems like Asha Bhosle is getting younger with age. Listen to *Aisa jalta hai jiya* to believe it.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit